Data-Centric Techniques:

Advanced Data Curation, Filtering, and Selection

1. Semantic-Based Data Filtering and Semantic Deduplication
2. Density-Based Data Selection and Sequence Packing
3. Dual-Consideration Density Computation
4. Data Curation and Data Acquisition
5. Intra-Domain Curation via Determinantal Point Processes (DPPs) and Coresets
6. Inter-Domain Curation via Distributional Divergence
7. Data Engineering for 128k+ Long-Context Scaling
8. Data Pruning
9. Topic Segmentation

Data Synthesis, Augmentation, and Distillation

10. Synthetic Long-Context Splicing (VideoWeave)
11. Semi-Automatic Data Enrichment / Annotation via Teacher Models
12. Impossible Distillation and Self-Data Distillation
13. Graph-Based Synthetic Layout Generation
14. Contextual Wikipedia Section Summarization
15. Large-scale Artificial Disfluency (LARD) Generation
16. Active Learning and Active Prompting
17. Visual Instruction Tuning
18. Self-Instruct / Self-Generated Instructions

Spatial and Temporal Compression (Visual Token Reduction)

19. Semantic-Aware Key-Frame Extraction (Temporal Dynamic Compression)
20. Differential Keyframe Selection (DKS)
21. Attention-Based Frame Scoring
22. Magnitude-Based Spatial Token Pruning
23. Semantic Token Merging
24. Differential Feature Merging (DFM)
25. Query-Agnostic Temporal Segmentation (C-DPCKNN)
26. Fixed-Size Extreme Image Pooling (1TPI), 1D Pooling, and 2D Pooling
27. Adaptive Visual Token Compression via Intrinsic Information (LLaVA-Zip)
28. Spatiotemporal Adaptive Compression

Structural Formatting and Inference Contextualization

29. Discrete Temporal Tokenization
30. Structural Image Partitioning
31. Specialized Spatial-Temporal Demarcation Tokens

32. Inference Contextualization and ContextCite Attribution
33. Repeated Sampling for Inference Scaling
34. Visual Sketchpad / Video-of-Thought (VoT)
35. Many-Shot In-Context Learning
36. Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) Contextualization
37. LM-Corrector (LMCOR) Loop
38. Context-Aware Decoding (CAD)
39. Context-Faithful Prompting (CFP)
40. Iterative Refinement with Self-Feedback

Data Attribution, Valuation, and Alignment

41. Data Valuation, Data Shapley, and Influence Functions
42. Data-Centric Statistical Watermarking and Machine/Target Unlearning
43. Context Direct Preference Optimization (Context DPO)

Group-Wise Algorithmic Detail:

1. Advanced Data Curation, Filtering, and Selection

This overarching category represents a paradigm shift in artificial intelligence, moving away from purely scaling model parameters (model-centric) and instead focusing meticulously on evaluating, cleaning, and filtering datasets prior to training. By ensuring maximum information density and removing noise, these techniques prevent model bias, mitigate diminishing returns, and significantly enhance reasoning capabilities.

Semantic-Based Data Filtering and Semantic Deduplication To prevent content homogenization and maintain thematic diversity in training datasets, this technique leverages language models to extract high-level semantic expressions from data. For instance, in video datasets, a model generates short captions for candidate videos, which are then encoded using a language model (e.g., BERT) to obtain a global semantic CLS token. A new data sample is only added to the final training pool if its maximum cosine similarity to the already selected samples falls below a strict, predefined threshold. At the web scale, semantic deduplication identifies and removes semantically redundant data points, drastically improving data efficiency. *Papers: ShareGPT4Video* pipeline methodologies and *SemDeDup: Data-efficient learning at web-scale through semantic deduplication*.

Density-Based Data Selection and Sequence Packing This technique addresses the inefficiencies of training on highly redundant data by selecting samples based on a "metric density" calculation, resulting in a low-density dataset that provides more unique information per sample. By prioritizing low-density data, the model avoids learning from repetitive clusters, shifting performance improvements from a decelerating power-law curve to a highly efficient linear growth curve. Additionally, sequence packing is employed during data preprocessing to concatenate diverse examples—often from different domains—into a single sequence. This minimizes inefficient padding tokens and introduces valuable domain variability within the same training batch. *Papers: Revisiting Scaling Laws for Language Models: The Role of Data Quality and Training Strategies* and *How to train data-efficient LLMs*.

Dual-Consideration Density Computation Unlike traditional data pruning that relies on general similarities, this advanced mathematical technique calculates the "information density" of a dataset across two specific axes: intra-cluster concentration and inter-cluster separation. It computes the ratio of samples within a specific cluster to its volume (concentration) and measures the centroid distances between different clusters (separation) using a weighted dataset radius. This dual consideration directly combats the "sub-scaling law" by aggressively discarding data that falls into highly dense, redundant clusters, ensuring that every retained sample provides maximum information gain. *Paper: Revisiting Scaling Laws for Language Models: The Role of Data Quality and Training Strategies*.

Data Curation and Data Acquisition This refers to the broad, foundational strategies utilized to identify, source, and clean high-quality unstructured data from the web or closed domains. Research strongly indicates that the quality of curated data plays a far more crucial role in

model capability than sheer data quantity or model architecture. Efficient data acquisition pipelines seek to build diverse, web-scale corpora while filtering out low-quality, toxic, or redundant information to build robust foundation models. *Papers: Data acquisition: A new frontier in data-centric AI* and *Dolma: an Open Corpus of Three Trillion Tokens for Language Model Pretraining Research*.

Intra-Domain Curation via Determinantal Point Processes (DPPs) and Coresets When curating data strictly within a specific, fine-grained domain (such as medical or legal texts), the goal is to maximize the internal diversity of the data pool. This technique integrates classical machine learning strategies—specifically Determinantal Point Processes (DPPs) and coreset selection—to ensure the selected subset accurately represents the entire domain's distribution without redundancy. This prevents the model from overfitting on repetitive, domain-specific jargon. *Papers:* Contextualized in LLM data surveys, drawing on *Determinantal Point Processes for Machine Learning* and *Active learning for convolutional neural networks: A core-set approach*.

Inter-Domain Curation via Distributional Divergence When constructing massive datasets by mixing multiple different fields or domains, it is critical to maximize overall heterogeneity. This technique evaluates potential new domains and incrementally adds them to the training pool only if they mathematically increase the heterogeneity of the data. This is determined by running rigorous statistical tests or measuring distributional divergence against the existing dataset, ensuring the model develops highly generalizable knowledge. *Papers:* Contextualized in LLM data surveys, drawing on *A theory of learning from different domains* and *DAVINZ: Data valuation using deep neural networks at initialization*.

Data Engineering for 128k+ Long-Context Scaling To effectively scale a language model's context window to 128,000 tokens or beyond, simple parameter adjustments are insufficient. This technique focuses on meticulously engineering the distribution of document lengths within the training data and deliberately curating multi-document concatenations. By exposing the model to specifically formatted, extended contexts during training, it learns to reliably retrieve and process information spanning massive sequences without suffering from attention degradation in the middle of the prompt. *Paper: Data engineering for scaling language models to 128k context*.

Data Pruning Data pruning involves identifying and discarding a large fraction of a dataset that is deemed redundant, low-quality, or uninformative, while retaining the core examples that drive learning. By intelligently pruning web-scale datasets based on the complexity of concept clusters or example difficulty, researchers have demonstrated the ability to consistently beat traditional power-law scaling trends. This allows models to reach higher performance thresholds using significantly fewer computational resources. *Papers: Beyond neural scaling laws: beating power law scaling via data pruning*, *When less is more: Investigating data pruning for pretraining llms at scale*, and *Effective pruning of web-scale datasets based on complexity of concept clusters*.

Topic Segmentation To help models parse unstructured, long-form content, topic segmentation algorithms are applied to automatically divide texts, videos, or spoken documents into logical, coherent partitions. By analyzing visual, acoustic, or textual features to identify scene or topic transitions, this curation technique provides clear boundaries for events. This prevents the model from conflating unrelated contexts and greatly improves downstream retrieval and reasoning accuracy. *Papers: Sector: A neural model for coherent topic segmentation and classification*, *Multi-modal video topic segmentation with dual-contrastive domain adaptation*, and *Sequence model with self-adaptive sliding window for efficient spoken document segmentation*.

2. Data Synthesis, Augmentation, and Distillation

This overarching category represents a paradigm shift away from relying on expensive, labor-intensive human annotation. Instead, these techniques utilize advanced generative models to synthetically create, enrich, or distill data. By leveraging Large Language Models (LLMs) and Vision-Language Models (VLMs) to iteratively bootstrap and filter their own training data, developers can massively increase dataset information density and scale in a highly cost-effective manner.

Synthetic Long-Context Splicing (VideoWeave)

- **Paper:** *VIDEOWEAVE: A Data-Centric Approach for Efficient Video Understanding*.
- **Expansion:** Because manually annotating long-form videos is prohibitively expensive and processing them requires massive compute, **this technique synthetically constructs extended temporal contexts by concatenating multiple short, independently captioned video segments into a single continuous input stream**. By grouping multiple videos together and simply appending their original captions with a whitespace, the model is forced to learn complex temporal tracking, cross-domain task composition, and scene-boundary recognition. This reorganizes existing video-text pairs to expand temporal diversity without requiring architectural modifications or increased training budgets.

Semi-Automatic Data Enrichment / Annotation via Teacher Models

- **Paper:** *Video-ChatGPT: Towards Detailed Video Understanding via Large Vision and Language Models*.
- **Expansion:** Raw, web-scraped video captions are often too brief for complex reasoning. This framework **harnesses off-the-shelf, dense Vision-Language Models to semi-automatically generate highly descriptive, enriched annotations**. First, models like BLIP-2 generate frame-level captions, while models like GRiT extract dense scene object descriptions. An advanced LLM (such as GPT-3.5 or GPT-4V) then merges these disparate inputs into a singular, contextually rich video-level caption. During this process, the LLM is explicitly instructed to discard inconsistent visual noise, ensuring the final synthetic data captures precise spatial aspects, object relationships, and chronological event sequences.

Impossible Distillation and Self-Data Distillation

- **Paper:** *Impossible Distillation: from low-quality model to high-quality dataset & model for summarization and paraphrasing*.
- **Expansion:** This methodology **bypasses human annotation by using an LLM as an automated "selector" to iteratively filter, correct, and bootstrap its own training data**. Even if a model cannot perfectly synthesize high-quality labels from scratch, it can be used to evaluate a pool of generated candidates, effectively discarding low-quality or noisy data and leaving only the pristine labels for training. In multimodal contexts like speculative decoding, *Self-Distilled Visual Instruction Tuning (SDViT)* uses a massive target VLM to generate responses across varying temperatures, creating a self-distilled dataset that perfectly aligns a smaller draft model's token distribution with the target model's actual outputs.

Graph-Based Synthetic Layout Generation

- **Paper:** *Enhancing document AI data generation through graph-based synthetic layouts* / *FS-DAG: Few shot domain adapting graph networks for visually rich document understanding*.
- **Expansion:** To address the severe scarcity of real-world annotated documents (which are often restricted by privacy), this technique **programmatically generates diverse and highly complex synthetic training data using domain-adapting graph networks**. By computationally synthesizing structurally perfect document layouts and spatial arrangements, models can be trained on visually rich document understanding tasks without needing access to manual human annotations.

Contextual Wikipedia Section Summarization

- **Paper:** *WIT: Wikipedia-based Image Text Dataset for Multimodal Multilingual Machine Learning*.
- **Expansion:** To elevate pretraining data quality above shallow, noisy internet alt-text, **this curation strategy explicitly pairs images scraped from Wikipedia pages with their surrounding contextual section text**. The surrounding text is programmatically summarized to serve as a highly dense, knowledge-rich image caption. This ensures that the generated dataset ties visual features to deep, factual, and multilingual world knowledge rather than simple, surface-level object tags.

Large-scale Artificial Disfluency (LARD) Generation

- **Paper:** *(Specific paper title is not explicitly detailed in the provided literature, but the concept is established in our conversation history).*
- **Expansion:** This pipeline **artificially injects stutters, pauses, and grammatical disfluencies into pristine training text or speech datasets**. By systematically introducing these natural human speech errors into the training data programmatically, the model is natively prepared to handle and process the messy, unstructured nature of

real-world human interactions, bridging the gap between sanitized training environments and noisy real-world deployments.

Active Learning and Active Prompting

- **Paper:** *Active Prompting with Chain-of-Thought for Large Language Models* and *Deep Bayesian Active Learning with Image Data*.
- **Expansion:** In scenarios with massive pools of unlabeled data and limited computational budgets, **Active Learning focuses on mathematically identifying and selecting only the most "useful" or highly uncertain data points for annotation**. Active Prompting extends this by utilizing the generative power of LLMs to automatically synthesize both coherent inputs and corresponding labels for those high-value data points via advanced prompt engineering. By leveraging uncertainty modeling and feature-based diversity, these methods maximize the cost-effectiveness of data synthesis, ensuring optimal model performance using the absolute minimum number of synthesized labels.

Visual Instruction Tuning

- **Paper:** *Visual Instruction Tuning* and *Improved Baselines with Visual Instruction Tuning*.
- **Expansion:** This foundational technique **adapts image-pretrained foundation models to complex multimodal tasks by fine-tuning them on machine-generated, instruction-following data**. Advanced LLMs (like GPT-4) are provided with image captions and bounding boxes to synthetically generate rich conversational turns and reasoning instructions. By training a visual connector alongside the language model on these synthetic dialogues, the system learns to effectively map visual tokens into the language space, unlocking powerful zero-shot capabilities and dynamic human-intent alignment.

Self-Instruct / Self-Generated Instructions

- **Paper:** *Self-Instruct: Aligning Language Models with Self-Generated Instructions*.
- **Expansion:** To circumvent the massive labor required to hand-write instructional datasets, **this method enables language models to bootstrap their own instruction-following capabilities by autonomously generating their own training prompts and responses**. Starting with a small seed set of human instructions, the model prompts itself to create diverse, novel tasks and reasoning traces. The model synthesizes this vast pool of instructional data, filters it for quality, and then fine-tunes itself on the resulting dataset, drastically improving its general alignment through self-generative synthesis.

3. Spatial and Temporal Compression (Visual Token Reduction)

This is the overarching category of data-centric techniques designed to manipulate the physical structure of visual data. Because videos and high-resolution images produce an exorbitant number of visual tokens that quickly exhaust an LLM's context window

and VRAM, these techniques actively prune, merge, and select specific frames or spatial patches. This allows models to process vast amounts of visual information while adhering to strict computational budgets.

Semantic-Aware Key-Frame Extraction (Temporal Dynamic Compression)

- **Papers:** *ShareGPT4Video* and *D-CoDe: Scaling Image-Pretrained VLMs to Video via Dynamic Compression*.
- **Expansion:** Standard uniform frame sampling blindly skips critical moments. To counter this, semantic-aware extraction aims to balance the reduction of temporal redundancy with the preservation of semantic coherence. In *ShareGPT4Video*, the CLIP CLS token is used as a global semantic representation for each frame, and adjacent frames with a semantic similarity exceeding a strict threshold are discarded. In *D-CoDe*, this is implemented as "Temporal Dynamic Compression," which first samples a base ratio of frames uniformly, and then iteratively selects "supplementary frames" from the unchosen candidates. These supplementary frames are specifically chosen because they possess the *lowest* cosine similarity (highest semantic variation) to the existing frame set, guaranteeing that rapid, visually distinct actions are captured,.

Differential Keyframe Selection (DKS)

- **Paper:** *Scaling Video-Language Models to 10K Frames via Hierarchical Differential Distillation* (ViLAMP).
- **Expansion:** This technique identifies salient keyframes by maximizing query relevance while strictly maintaining temporal distinctiveness. It uses a greedy algorithm that first ranks all video frames in descending order based on their cosine similarity to the user's text query,. It then iteratively selects these highly relevant frames, but only adds a frame to the keyframe set if its semantic similarity to the already selected frames falls below a temporal distance threshold (τ). **This mathematically guarantees that the model processes the most relevant visual information without wasting compute on redundant, temporally identical clusters**.

Attention-Based Frame Scoring

- **Paper:** *Mobile-VideoGPT: A Lightweight Multimodal Model Designed for Real-Time Video Understanding*.
- **Expansion:** Designed specifically for edge devices, this technique deterministically filters out non-essential frames before they reach the heavy temporal encoders,. The pipeline extracts spatial features using a CLIP encoder and computes a spatial attention matrix across all flattened spatial tokens. It then sums the attention scores that each token receives to produce a frame-wise importance vector. By ranking these scores, it explicitly selects only the *top-K* frames (e.g., discarding 50% of the video) to feed into the temporal encoder, drastically reducing the computational load while preserving key actions.

Magnitude-Based Spatial Token Pruning

- **Paper:** *D-CoDe: Scaling Image-Pretrained VLMs to Video via Dynamic Compression*.
- **Expansion:** Because spatial backgrounds (like walls or skies) offer little semantic value, this technique actively prunes uninformative visual noise within individual frames,. It computes the L_2 norm (activation magnitude) of all visual patch tokens in a frame and uses this magnitude as a direct proxy for visual salience. Tokens that fall below a predefined retention ratio (β) are aggressively discarded,. **This significantly reduces the LLM's spatial token burden without losing core subject details**,.

Semantic Token Merging

- **Paper:** *D-CoDe: Scaling Image-Pretrained VLMs to Video via Dynamic Compression*.
- **Expansion:** Following magnitude-based pruning, this technique further eliminates spatial redundancy by grouping the remaining high-saliency tokens. Tokens are evaluated against an anchor token, and if their cosine similarity exceeds a predefined threshold (τ), they are grouped into a "redundancy cluster",. These highly similar tokens (such as large patches of identical texture) are then consolidated into a single representative token via mean pooling,.

Differential Feature Merging (DFM)

- **Paper:** *Scaling Video-Language Models to 10K Frames via Hierarchical Differential Distillation* (ViLAMP).
- **Expansion:** Discarding non-keyframes entirely destroys the continuous temporal context of a video. DFM solves this by compressing non-keyframes down to a single representative token. It applies a differentially weighted pooling operation where individual patches within the non-keyframe are assigned weights. A patch receives a high weight if it has **high query relevance** but **low temporal redundancy** when compared to the exact same spatial patch in the preceding keyframe,. This ensures the model retains critical background context without exploding the token count.

Query-Agnostic Temporal Segmentation (C-DPCKNN)

- **Paper:** *VideoINSTA* (Referenced in framework ablations).
- **Expansion:** Standard clustering algorithms often scatter tokens from the same event across a video, blurring boundaries. C-DPCKNN (a consecutive density-based clustering algorithm) parses unstructured videos into logical, chronological "events". It evaluates frame-level representations to compute local density and distance indices, identifying "event centers". It explicitly sets strict event boundaries at the minimum density peaks (points of drastic content change), ensuring that the video is segmented into chronological chapters without interleaving disparate scenes,.

Fixed-Size Extreme Image Pooling (1TPI), 1D Pooling, and 2D Pooling

- **Papers:** *HotelMatch-LLM* (for 1TPI) and multimodality efficiency surveys, (for 1D/2D pooling).
- **Expansion:** To achieve extreme context scaling for long documents or numerous images, these techniques force massive pixel arrays into strict, fixed-size representations. **1TPI (One Token Per Image)** mathematically restricts an entire image to occupy just a single input token, achieved either by extracting the global CLIP CLS embedding (1TPI-CLS) or by averaging all patch embeddings together (1TPI-Patch). Similarly, **1D and 2D pooling** use dedicated spatial/temporal kernels to aggressively downsample feature maps, guaranteeing scalability for any number of images by preventing the dimensions from expanding regardless of the input volume,,.

Adaptive Visual Token Compression via Intrinsic Information (LLaVA-Zip)

- **Paper:** *LLaVA-Zip: Adaptive visual token compression with intrinsic image information*.
- **Expansion:** Rather than utilizing a flat, heuristic-based dropping mechanism for all images, this technique dynamically evaluates the intrinsic information density of specific image patches. It adaptively compresses visual tokens, retaining high-frequency and structurally complex details (such as small text or facial features) while aggressively compressing empty or low-information visual space, yielding a highly optimized, detail-oriented token stream.

Spatiotemporal Adaptive Compression

- **Paper:** *LongVU: Spatiotemporal adaptive compression for long video-language understanding*,,.
- **Expansion:** Designed specifically for hour-long video processing, this technique bypasses rigid compression rules. It dynamically alters the compression ratio across both spatial dimensions (frame resolution) and temporal dimensions (framerate) based entirely on the specific complexity and variation of the current video scene,. By dynamically allocating token budgets where they are most needed, it makes extended video understanding computationally viable on constrained hardware.

4. Structural Formatting and Inference Contextualization

This represents the overarching data-centric paradigm for the techniques listed below. Rather than altering a model's neural weights or expanding its parameter count, these methodologies focus entirely on manipulating how the raw data sequence is formatted, how prompts are orchestrated, and how the model interacts with information at test-time (inference). This approach shifts the cognitive burden from the model's static, parametric memory to its dynamic context window, unlocking massive capability leaps efficiently.

Discrete Temporal Tokenization Continuous, floating-point timestamps are inherently difficult for Large Language Models to tokenize and process efficiently due to their continuous numerical nature. This technique completely eliminates raw timestamps by dividing a video's timeline into equal-length chunks (e.g., M chunks) and mapping them to a discrete artificial vocabulary (e.g., `<0>` to `<M>`). This mathematical normalization of time places temporal boundaries and text

into a unified semantic embedding space, eliminating timestamp quantization errors and allowing the model to seamlessly predict both timestamps and textual outputs in a single sequence of discrete tokens.

- **Papers:** Introduced in foundational dense captioning works like *Vid2Seq: Large-scale pretraining of a visual language model for dense video captioning* (Yang et al., 2023) and aggressively refined in *Grounded-VideoLLM: Sharpening Fine-grained Temporal Grounding in Video Large Language Models*.

Structural Image Partitioning To counteract the severe information loss that occurs when high-resolution images are compressed into a strict token budget, this technique partitions a single high-resolution image into multiple lower-resolution sub-images or "patches" before feeding them into the model. To preserve the structural integrity of the original image, these partitioned sub-images are typically ordered in a top-left to bottom-right raster scan, allowing the model to process fine-grained details without losing the global spatial context.

- **Papers:** Explored deeply in frameworks like *LongLLaVA: Scaling Multi-modal LLMs to 1000 Images Efficiently*.

Specialized Spatial-Temporal Demarcation Tokens To ensure that language models can explicitly understand the spatial layouts and temporal flow of flattened token sequences without relying on black-box visual projectors, this formatting technique injects specialized textual vocabulary tokens directly into the data stream. For video inputs, the entire sequence of frame tokens is enclosed within `<vid>` and `</vid>` tags, and a `<t>` token is inserted between consecutive frames to signal chronological dependency. For high-resolution partitioned images, a `\n` (newline) token is inserted between rows of sub-images to explicitly preserve their relative spatial positions within the linearized input.

- **Papers:** *LongLLaVA: Scaling Multi-modal LLMs to 1000 Images Efficiently*.

Inference Contextualization and ContextCite Attribution This technique addresses the critical need for source attribution by tracing specific generated output tokens back to the exact contextual source data provided in the user's prompt. It creates highly interpretable generation, allowing developers and users to detect exactly which part of a provided document or context caused the model to hallucinate or generate a specific claim, ensuring legal and factual reliability.

- **Papers:** *ContextCite: Attributing Model Generation to Context* (Cohen-Wang et al., 2024).

Repeated Sampling for Inference Scaling Rather than scaling up the parameters of the model to improve performance, this technique scales up *test-time compute*. It forces the model to generate multiple diverse candidate responses and reasoning paths for a single query. A consensus mechanism, verifier, or oracle is then utilized to evaluate the candidate pool and

select the best answer. This proves that giving a smaller model more compute time to "think" and sample at inference can match or beat a massive model running a single zero-shot pass.

- **Papers:** *Large Language Monkeys: Scaling Inference Compute with Repeated Sampling* (Brown et al., 2024).

Visual Sketchpad / Video-of-Thought (VoT) A prompting and orchestration technique that shifts the cognitive burden during complex visual tasks by explicitly instructing the model to engage in step-by-step reasoning or to create a "visual sketchpad" before arriving at a final answer. Instead of demanding a zero-shot guess, it bridges sketch-based reasoning with image analysis to enhance interactive reasoning, severely reducing spatial hallucinations by forcing the model to sequentially analyze fine-grained spatial-temporal scene graphs.

- **Papers:** *Visual Sketchpad: Sketching as a Visual Chain of Thought for Multimodal Language Models* (Hu et al., 2024).

Many-Shot In-Context Learning Instead of the traditional zero-shot or few-shot prompting limits, this technique packs the model's extended context window with hundreds or even thousands of high-quality demonstration pairs before the actual query. This massive injection of data at inference time temporarily overrides the model's pre-trained biases, forcing it to strictly adhere to the specific logic, tone, and formatting demonstrated in the prompt without requiring expensive fine-tuning.

- **Papers:** *Many-Shot In-Context Learning* (Agarwal et al., 2024) and *Many-Shot In-Context Learning in Multimodal Foundation Models* (Jiang et al., 2024).

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) Contextualization This technique dynamically bypasses a model's static, parametric knowledge limits. When a user issues a query, a retriever algorithm searches a massive external datastore of unstructured data (documents, videos) or structured data (knowledge graphs) to find the most highly relevant information. This retrieved data is then injected into the prompt alongside the query, contextualizing the inference process and anchoring the model's generated output in verifiable facts.

- **Papers:** Highlighted in data-centric overviews like *Data-Centric AI in the Age of Large Language Models* and the foundational *Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks* (Lewis et al., 2020).

LM-Corrector (LMCOR) Loop An inference-stage methodology designed to perfectly synthesize outputs. The primary language model is prompted to sample multiple diverse candidate responses to a single query. These candidates are then fed into a separate, highly efficient Small Language Model (SLM) acting as the "Corrector". The corrector model evaluates the candidates and optimally splices together the best, most accurate spans from each to form a singular, superior final output, matching fine-tuned performance without updating weights.

- **Papers:** *Don’t rank, combine! Combining machine translation hypotheses using quality estimation* (Vernikos and Popescu-Belis, 2024).

Context-Aware Decoding (CAD) An unsupervised decoding strategy designed to force a model to respect the provided prompt context. During the token-generation phase, CAD dynamically adjusts the output token probabilities, heavily penalizing tokens that rely solely on the model's prior parametric knowledge while boosting the probability of tokens grounded in the explicitly provided evidence.

- **Papers:** *Trusting your evidence: Hallucinate less with context-aware decoding* (Shi et al., 2024).

Context-Faithful Prompting (CFP) An unsupervised prompt optimization technique that explicitly structures prompts to guide large language models to remain faithful to the provided context. It is designed to mitigate hallucinations by establishing strict reasoning guardrails, reducing the likelihood of the model generating irrelevant information that is not directly supported by the context text.

- **Papers:** *Context-faithful prompting for large language models* (Zhou et al., 2023).

Iterative Refinement with Self-Feedback A post-hoc, zero-training correction loop where the language model generates an initial output and is subsequently prompted to evaluate its own work. The model generates a critical self-feedback response identifying flaws or missing context, and then utilizes that self-generated critique to iteratively refine and rewrite its response into a more accurate, highly aligned output.

- **Papers:** *Self-Refine: Iterative refinement with self-feedback* (Madaan et al., 2023).

5. Data Attribution, Valuation, and Alignment

This is an overarching category of security, alignment, and interpretability techniques designed to audit, assign worth to, and manipulate the influence of data after a model has ingested it, while ensuring the model remains faithful to the contexts it is provided.

Data Valuation, Data Shapley, and Influence Functions These are advanced mathematical frameworks utilized to trace the exact influence of individual training data points on a model's predictions or to equitably score the overall "value" of a data sample to the training pool. Traditional methods identify the most valuable training data, but applying these directly to Large Language Models (LLMs) poses severe challenges. The increasing complexity and sheer size of modern model architectures significantly deteriorate the accuracy and utility of exact influence scores while making the computational cost prohibitively expensive. To resolve this bottleneck, researchers have developed efficient approximations and direct empirical estimators. These approaches demonstrate massive computational speedups by reducing the original influence calculation to much smaller subproblems or by exploiting specific, highly efficient training structures.

- **Papers:** The foundational methodologies for these techniques are detailed in **"Data Shapley: Equitable valuation of data for machine learning"** (Ghorbani and Zou, 2019) and **"Understanding black-box predictions via influence functions"** (Koh and

Liang, 2017). Modern adaptations for massively scaled models are explored in **"What is your data worth to GPT? LLM-scale data valuation with influence functions"** (Choe et al., 2024).

Data-Centric Statistical Watermarking and Machine/Target Unlearning This combination of techniques is primarily motivated by the need to respect copyright, protect intellectual property, and mitigate toxic or harmful model outputs. **Data-centric watermarking** is used to identify and pinpoint the specific data sources that contribute most significantly to a generated output. By inserting unique identifiers—such as specific linguistic patterns or Unicode character-based watermarks—into a source's data during training, the model's generations can later be audited to correctly trace and attribute the output back to its intellectual creator. Once a target source is identified for removal (due to copyright requests or safety concerns), **Machine/Target Unlearning** is deployed. Because retraining a massive LLM from scratch without the target data is prohibitively expensive, researchers leverage targeted, cost-effective solutions. These include target data-oriented fine-tuning on the remaining data or utilizing "in-context unlearning" to mimic the erasure of specific knowledge through careful contextualization at inference time, successfully removing the influence of the data without triggering catastrophic forgetting.

- **Papers:** Source attribution and watermarking strategies are extensively covered in **"Attributing Fake Images to GANs: Learning and Analyzing GAN Fingerprints"** (Yu et al., 2019) and **"Artificial fingerprinting for generative models: Rooting deepfake attribution in training data"** (Yu et al., 2021). Unlearning methodologies are detailed in **"Large language model unlearning"** (Yao et al., 2023b) and **"In-context unlearning: Language models as few shot unlearners"** (Pawelczyk et al., 2023).

Context Direct Preference Optimization (Context DPO) This is an advanced alignment methodology designed to enforce strict context faithfulness in scenarios where a model must ground its reasoning exclusively in the provided external information. Rather than relying on unsupervised prompt engineering or decoding constraints, Context DPO utilizes a direct preference optimization framework. It actively guides the language model during training to explicitly prefer context-faithful outputs over answers that rely on hallucinated details or the model's internal pre-trained biases. By aligning the model's reward mechanisms directly with context-adherence, this technique significantly outperforms traditional unsupervised methods in ensuring reliable, evidence-based reasoning.

- **Paper:** This technique is introduced and explored in **"Context-DPO: Aligning language models for context-faithfulness"** (Bi et al., 2024).